

The Family Protection Gap Checker

Three numbers, about five minutes, and a pen. Nothing here is a quote and nothing here is advice — it is arithmetic you do yourself.

Most households have never actually worked out what happens if the income stops. Not emotionally — arithmetically. What comes in, what still has to be paid, and what is already in place to cover the difference.

That is what this page is. You fill it in. It does not calculate anything for you, it does not tell you what to buy, and it does not send anything anywhere. When you are done you will have a number, and the number is the point.

Before you start. Use real figures if you have them and honest estimates if you do not — an approximate number you wrote down beats an exact number you never looked up. Do it in one sitting. Do not stop to research anything; note the gaps and move on.

NUMBER ONE

What the household loses

If you died, got seriously ill, or were hurt badly enough to stop working tomorrow — what income disappears from this house?

Your take-home income, per month

Any income of yours the household would lose beyond salary
(side work, commission, business draw)

Employer benefits that stop with the job (list them; you may
need to check)

Monthly income lost

Now multiply by twelve, then by the number of years the household would still need it — until the mortgage is done, or the youngest child is grown, or whatever the honest horizon is for your family. Write the horizon down next to the number, because the horizon is half the answer.

**Years the household would need replacing × annual
income lost = NUMBER ONE**

NUMBER TWO

What debt would still be there

The debt does not care what happened to you. List what would still be owed, with nobody earning to service it.

Mortgage balance

Vehicle loans

Credit cards and consumer debt

Student loans (check which ones survive a death — some do,
some do not)

Business or personal loans you have guaranteed

Anything else somebody would have to settle

NUMBER TWO

If you want the fuller picture, add final expenses — a funeral, medical bills, the legal cost of settling an estate. Most people leave these off and they are real.

NUMBER THREE

What is actually in place

Not what you assume is in place. What you could name, today, without looking it up — and then what you find when you do look it up.

Life insurance through work (amount, and whether it survives leaving the job)

Life insurance you own personally

Disability cover (short term / long term — and what it actually replaces)

Savings and emergency fund the family could reach quickly

Retirement accounts (note: reaching these early usually costs something)

Anything else that would pay out

NUMBER THREE

The gap

Number one (income the household loses, over the horizon you wrote)

Plus number two (debt still standing)

Minus number three (what is already in place)

THE GAP

That is the number. I am deliberately not going to tell you what it means, because I do not know your situation, and any page that tells you what your own number means without knowing anything about you is selling you something.

What I will say is that most people have never seen it before, and that seeing it is the part that changes things. Sometimes it comes out smaller than the person feared and they get to stop worrying — that is a completely legitimate result and a good day. Sometimes it is bigger.

Either way you now know, and knowing is the whole job.

If you want to talk about it

You do not have to. The worksheet is yours whether or not we ever speak, and nobody is going to call you because you filled it in.

If you do want a conversation, reply to the email this came with and tell me what came out. I would rather lose a sale than put somebody in something that is wrong for their actual situation, so it may well be a short conversation.

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